ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

# GRADE 6

# SOCIAL SCIENCES

## PAPER 1 · PRACTICE A

**MARKS: 70** **TIME: 1½ hours**

**An end-of-year test on Grade 6 Social Sciences. Geography: map skills (latitude and longitude) and climate and vegetation around the world. History: democracy and citizenship in South Africa, and medicine through time.**

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 6. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

## INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper has TWO sections: SECTION A (Geography) and SECTION B (History). Answer ALL the questions.
2. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
3. Read each question carefully before you answer.
4. Write in full sentences where you are asked to explain.

## SECTION A: GEOGRAPHY

## QUESTION 1: MAP SKILLS: LATITUDE AND LONGITUDE

Study FIGURE 1. It shows lines of latitude and longitude and four places, A, B, C and D.

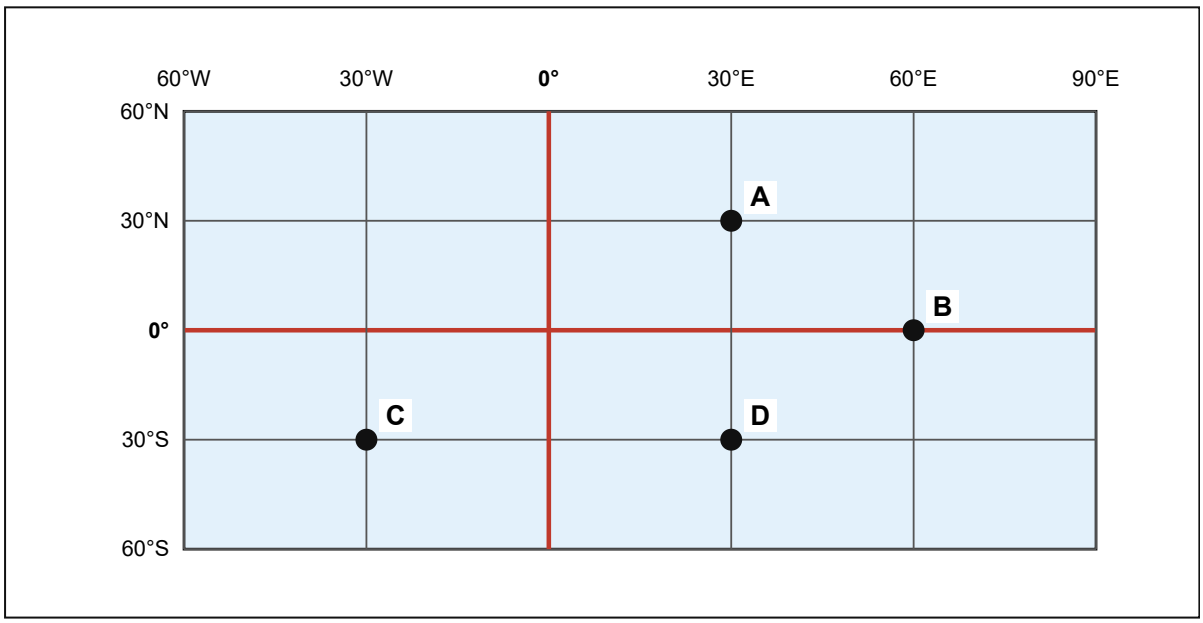



**FIGURE 1: Lines of latitude and longitude**

**1.1** Name the line of latitude marked 0°. (1)

**1.2** Name the line of longitude marked 0°. (1)

**1.3** Give the position (latitude and longitude) of point A and of point C. (4)

**1.4** Durban in South Africa is at about 30°S 31°E. Which point is closest to Durban? (1)

**1.5** Which point is in the Northern Hemisphere? (1)

**1.6** Do lines of latitude run from east to west, or from north to south? (1)

**1.7** Name TWO continents that lie completely in the Southern Hemisphere, and the ocean between Africa and Australia. (3)

**[12]**

## QUESTION 2: CLIMATE AND VEGETATION AROUND THE WORLD

**2.1** Choose the correct climate region from the box for each description. Write only the name next to the question number.

| tropical rainforest · desert · savanna · Mediterranean · polar |
|---|

2.1.1 Hot and wet all year; tall trees grow very close together (1)

2.1.2 Very little rain; very hot days and cold nights; plants such as cacti (1)

2.1.3 Grassland with scattered trees; hot, wet summers and dry winters (1)

2.1.4 Hot, dry summers and cool, wet winters, like Cape Town (1)

2.1.5 Very cold all year with ice and snow; only mosses and small plants grow in summer (1)

**2.2** Why is it hotter near the Equator than at the North and South Poles? (2)

**2.3** Name ONE desert in Africa. (1)

**2.4** Give TWO ways that desert plants are adapted to live with very little water. (2)

**2.5** Give TWO reasons why tropical rainforests are important to the world. (2)

**2.6** Give ONE reason why people cut down rainforests, and ONE result of cutting them down. (2)

**2.7** Much of South Africa is savanna (bushveld). Name TWO animals that live in the savanna. (2)

**2.8** Explain how the climate of a place affects the kind of houses people build there. Give ONE example. (2)

**2.9** Explain how climate affects which crops farmers can grow. Give ONE example. (2)

**2.10** What is natural vegetation? (1)

**2.11** Give TWO ways people use the trees from forests. (2)

**[23]**

**TOTAL SECTION A: [35]**

## SECTION B: HISTORY

## QUESTION 3: DEMOCRACY AND CITIZENSHIP IN SOUTH AFRICA

**3.1** Choose the correct answer. Write only the letter (A–D) next to the question number.

3.1.1 South Africa's first democratic election, in which all adults could vote, was held in … (1)

A 1948. B 1976. C 1994. D 2010.

3.1.2 The first democratically elected president of South Africa was … (1)

A F.W. de Klerk. B Nelson Mandela.
C Thabo Mbeki. D Desmond Tutu.

3.1.3 The highest law in South Africa is the … (1)

A Constitution. B Parliament.
C school rules. D police.

3.1.4 In South Africa, a citizen may vote from the age of … (1)

A 12. B 16. C 18. D 21.

3.1.5 Freedom Day, which remembers the first democratic election, is on … (1)

A 27 April. B 16 June. C 24 September. D 16 December.

**3.2** What is democracy? (2)

**3.3** Under apartheid, most South Africans were not allowed to vote. Give TWO other ways in which apartheid was unfair. (2)

**3.4** Read SOURCE A and answer the questions.

> **SOURCE A: Election day, April 1994**
>
> In April 1994 almost 20 million South Africans voted in the country's first democratic election. In many places people stood in long queues for hours. For many older people it was the first time in their lives that they were allowed to vote.

3.4.1 Why were people willing to wait in queues for hours? (2)

3.4.2 About how many people voted in this election? (1)

**3.5** The Bill of Rights lists the rights of everyone in South Africa. Name TWO rights, and give a responsibility that goes with each one. (4)

**3.6** Name the THREE spheres (levels) of government in South Africa. (3)

**[19]**

## QUESTION 4: MEDICINE THROUGH TIME

**4.1** Name ONE kind of traditional healer in South Africa. (1)

**4.2** Give ONE way in which traditional medicine and modern medicine work together today. (1)

**4.3** Choose a discovery from COLUMN B that matches each person in COLUMN A. Write only the letter (A–D) next to the question number. (4)

| COLUMN A | COLUMN B |
|---|---|
| 4.3.1 Edward Jenner | A Did the world's first human heart transplant, in Cape Town in 1967 |
| 4.3.2 Louis Pasteur | B Discovered penicillin, the first antibiotic, in 1928 |
| 4.3.3 Alexander Fleming | C Made the first vaccine, against smallpox, in 1796 |
| 4.3.4 Christiaan Barnard | D Showed that germs cause disease, and found a way to kill germs in milk by heating it |

**4.4** What is a vaccine, and why is it important? (2)

**4.5** Long ago, people did not know about germs. Give TWO things we do today to stop germs from spreading. (2)

**4.6** Give TWO ways in which medicine has changed since long ago. (2)

**4.7** In which hospital did the first human heart transplant take place? (1)

**4.8** Name ONE plant that is used as medicine in South Africa, and say what it is used for. (2)

**4.9** Why is it important to finish all your medicine, the way the doctor or nurse tells you to? (1)

**[16]**

**TOTAL SECTION B: [35]**

**TOTAL: 70**

**END OF QUESTION PAPER**